



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*yāvato grasate grāsān havya.kavyeṣv a.mantravit | 3.133a[123Ma]
tāvato grasate preto dīptaśūla.ṛṣṭi.ayoguḍān || 133 || 3.133c[123Mc]
jñānaniṣṭhā dvijāḥ ke cit taponiṣṭhās tathā-apare | 3.134a[124Ma]
tapaḥ.svādhyāyaniṣṭhās ca karmaniṣṭhās tathā-apare || 134 || 3.134c[124Mc]*

— Manusmṛti, 3.2.2.2. Quality of Invitees (Chapter 2), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Manusmṛiti delve into the profound connection between offerings, the quality of those who partake, and the spiritual consequences of our actions. The initial verse paints a stark picture: if you invite someone to a ritual offering (havya) or a funerary offering (kavya) who lacks knowledge of the sacred mantras, then for every morsel they consume, the deceased ancestors suffer equivalent torments in the afterlife, symbolized by burning spears and iron balls. This isn't about literal suffering, but rather the disruption of the spiritual harmony intended by the offering. The lack of proper knowledge and intention pollutes the ritual, hindering its efficacy and potentially causing spiritual imbalances.

The subsequent verse then shifts to the desirable qualities of those who should be invited to these sacred meals. It speaks of those dedicated to knowledge (jñānaniṣṭhā), those steadfast in asceticism (taponiṣṭhā), those committed to both asceticism and scriptural study (tapaḥ.svādhyāyaniṣṭhā), and those devoted to righteous action (karmaniṣṭhā). These individuals, through their dedication and spiritual discipline, possess the capacity to truly receive and transmit the blessings intended by the offerings. Their presence elevates the ritual, ensuring its positive impact on both the living and the departed.

In modern life, this passage offers valuable insights into the importance of intention and the power of association. When you engage in acts of generosity, consider the motivations and qualities of those who benefit. Are you supporting individuals or organizations that align with your values and contribute to the greater good? Are you surrounding yourself with people who inspire you to live a more virtuous and meaningful life? The principle extends beyond formal rituals to encompass all aspects of your interactions. By choosing to associate with individuals who embody wisdom, compassion, and integrity, you enhance your own spiritual well-being and create a more positive ripple effect in the world. Just as the presence of knowledgeable individuals elevates a ritual, the presence of virtuous people elevates your life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are your actions and associations aligned with your deepest spiritual aspirations, and how might you cultivate more mindful choices in your daily life?